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APPS



**Spotify expands
audiobooks access to
family plan members in the
US for the first time**

Sarah Perez — 7:00 AM PDT · August 5, 2025

Spotify is expanding access to its audiobooks to more U.S. subscribers. The company on Tuesday announced the launch of its \$11.99 per month Audiobooks+ plan in the market, which allows subscribers or their household members on a Family or Duo plan to enjoy audiobook listening during the month on top of the base plan.

Though Spotify **launched** its audiobooks service in the U.S. back in 2019, audiobook listening was only available on Duo and Family plans. Our audiobooks subscriber catalog is now available to plan members with this add-on. have long been left out.

The offering makes audiobooks available to household members for the first time in the U.S. market.

Through Spotify Premium, subscribers already have access to 15 hours of audiobook listening per month and can buy additional hours on top of that, as needed. However, the Audiobooks+ plan gives subscribers the option to add recurring access to 15 additional hours every month, on top of the Premium plan's existing monthly allotment.

While that may be overkill for any but the more voracious audiobook listeners, the U.S. rollout of Audiobooks+ also means that other members on a subscription plan besides the cardholder can now also access Spotify's audiobooks catalog for the first time. This is made possible through the add-on called "Audiobooks+ for Plan Members."

With the launch, the U.S. joins a handful of other markets with access to Audiobooks+, including Ireland, Canada, the U.K., Australia, New Zealand, France, Belgium, the Netherlands, Luxembourg, Germany, Austria, Switzerland, and Liechtenstein.

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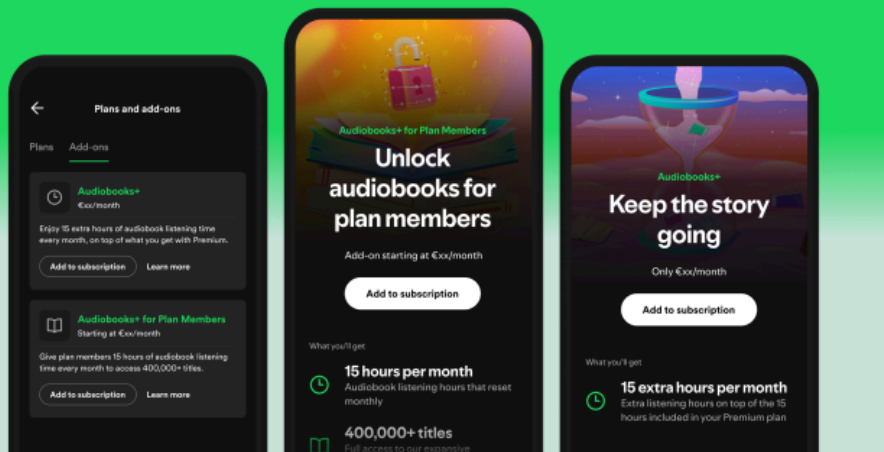


IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

The announcement of the plan’s expansion to the U.S. comes shortly after a [tough quarter](#) for the streaming giant, where it missed expectations and reported weak guidance. Spotify CEO Daniel Ek pointed to a weaker ads business as the cause. (Spotify’s ads chief had just left for DoorDash, media outlets reported ahead of earnings.)

Despite the loss, one bright spot for the company in the quarter was its user growth. Active users grew 11% to 696 million, and paid subscribers grew 12% to 276 million during the second quarter. The goal with the new Audiobooks+ plan is to extract more money from those existing customers.

In December, publisher HarperCollins teased a solution for the problem with household members’ inability to access audiobooks. HarperCollins CEO Brian Murray said at the time that Spotify was working to adjust a “technical problem” with family plans that limited audiobook streaming only to the family plan’s credit card holder.

Last month, Spotify made good on that promise when it [expanded](#) audiobook access to plan members for the first time with the launch of Audiobooks+ in several non-U.S. markets.

Spotify doesn’t share how many of its Premium subscribers stream audiobooks in addition to music or podcasts, but notes that audiobook listening hours are up more than 35% year-over-year in the U.S., U.K., and Australia. Notably, that’s before these add-on plans became available.

The news of the new subscription follows Spotify’s [announcement](#) on Monday that its subscription prices are

increasing from €10,99 to €11,99 across markets in the Middle East, Africa, Europe, Latin America, and the Asia-Pacific region.

Spotify says it will experiment with other options for book fans in the future, including direct sales.

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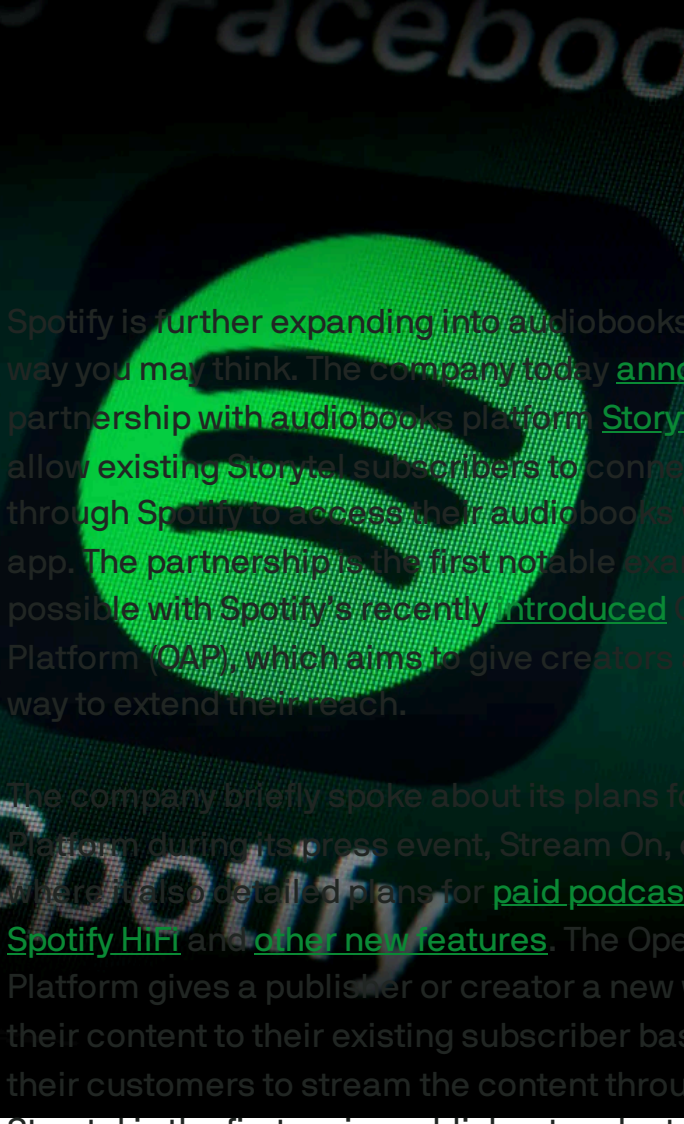
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Spotify expands into the audiobooks market by partnering with Storytel



Spotify is further expanding into audiobooks — but not in the way you may think. The company today [announced](#) a new partnership with audiobooks platform [Storytel](#), which will allow existing Storytel subscribers to connect their account through Spotify to access their audiobooks within Spotify’s app. The partnership is the first notable example of what’s possible with Spotify’s recently [introduced](#) Open Access Platform (OAP), which aims to give creators and publishers a way to extend their reach.

The company briefly spoke about its plans for Open Access Platform during its press event, Stream On, earlier this year, where it also detailed plans for [paid podcast subscriptions](#), [Spotify HiFi](#) and [other new features](#). The Open Access Platform gives a publisher or creator a new way to deliver their content to their existing subscriber base by allowing their customers to stream the content through Spotify.

Storytel is the first major publisher to adopt OAP, though Ben Thompson of Stratechery [did say](#) that he’s also using the platform.

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The technology supports using the creator or publisher’s existing login system and allows them to maintain direct control over their relationship with listeners. For example, a paid podcast could use the system to stream to existing subscribers. In Storytel’s case, however, the company offers audiobook content, not podcasts.

“We want everyone to have access to great stories, and today Storytel offers more than 500,000 audiobooks on a global basis across 25 markets,” said Jonas Tellander, Storytel founder and CEO, in the company’s [announcement](#).
“Partnering with Spotify make amazing audiobook experiences and exciting authorships easier than ever to access for our customers, while we will also be tapping into

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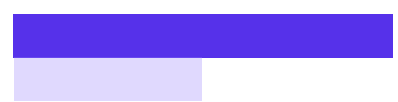
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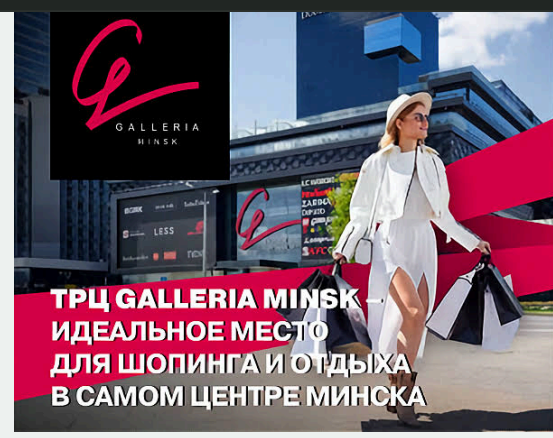
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Spotify today is officially rolling out paid podcast subscriptions, after first unveiling its new subscription platform at the company's "Stream On" event in February. Through Spotify's podcast creation tool Anchor, podcasters will be able to mark select episodes as subscriber-only content, then publish them to Spotify and other platforms. The service was initially tested with ... [Continue reading](#)



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The company has 1.6 million subscribers, per [a Reuters report](#). Spotify, meanwhile, has 356 million users, including 158 million subscribers across 178 markets.

The integration itself will go live later in 2021, allowing Storytel customers to sign into their accounts then stream through Spotify by linking their accounts. Spotify doesn't have plans to market to users to sign up for a Storytel subscription from its app at this time, but at the point of account linking, users could be directed to sign up instead of log in, if need be.

Spotify had dabbled in audiobooks before Storytel. In January this year, for example, it [began testing the format](#) with a handful of classics, like “Frankenstein,” “Jane Eyre,” “Persuasion” and others, narrated by celebs. It had also previously offered the first “Harry Potter” book with chapters narrated by stars like Daniel Radcliffe, David Beckham and Dakota Fanning.

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More partners for the Open Access Platform will be introduced this summer, Spotify says.

Spotify Group Session UX teardown: The fails and their fixes



We highlight some of Spotify Group Sessions user experience failings and offer ways to fix them, as well as a number of UX features that are done right.



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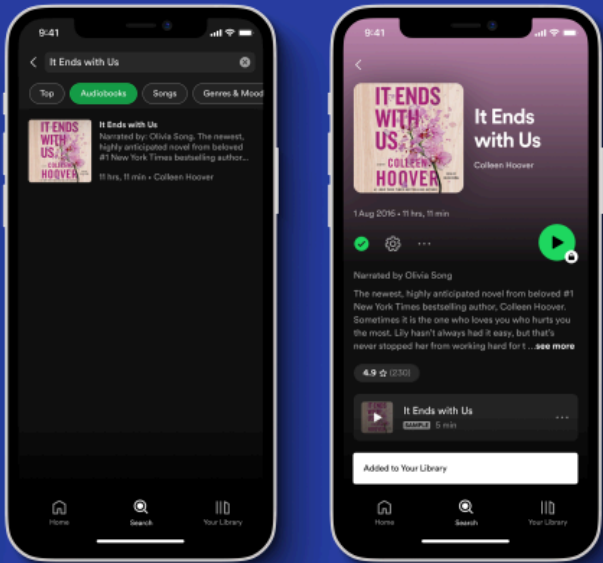
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Consumer News Editor |

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Spotify brings 15 hours of monthly audiobook listening to Premium subscribers in the US

Sarah Perez — 5:00 AM PST · November 8, 2023

Roughly a month after Spotify announced that a selection of [audiobooks would become a part of its Premium subscription](#), the company is today expanding the service to U.S. users for the first time. Subscribers will now have access to 15 hours of audiobook listening time per month across a catalog that includes 200,000 titles — up from the 150,000 available when the service first arrived in its initial markets of the U.K. and Australia.

Spotify originally introduced audiobooks to its streaming music platform in September 2022, following [its acquisition of the digital audiobook distributor Findaway in 2021](#). Its debut catalog included around 300,000 titles in the U.S., then began [expanding](#) to other English-speaking markets later in the year, with the addition of [Canada in early 2023](#).

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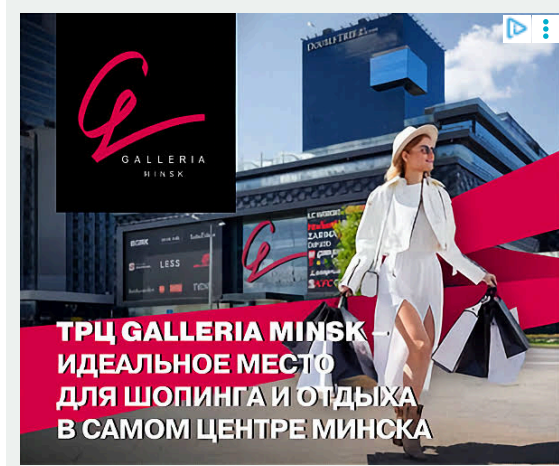
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The company has touted the potential to tap into a growing market with the addition, noting that audiobooks today are only a 6% to 7% share of the wider book market, but the category was growing by 20% year-over-year. Plus, Gen Z and millennials lead consumption of audiobooks, with 72% of 18- to 34-year-olds listening.

However, accessing Spotify's audiobooks was a cumbersome process at launch. Because Spotify didn't want to share commissions with the app stores on in-app purchases, users would have to first purchase the titles à la carte via Spotify's website before they could listen in-app. This introduced extra steps and made it more difficult to start listening. By bundling in a certain number of hours with its Premium subscription, the process became more seamless — now you can find the book you want and hit play to begin listening. In addition, if users want more time, they can purchase an extra 10 hours as a "top-off."

The books themselves are discoverable through the Spotify app's Home feed or by searching for a title. There's also an editorially curated selection of popular titles to browse in the app's [audiobooks hub](#).



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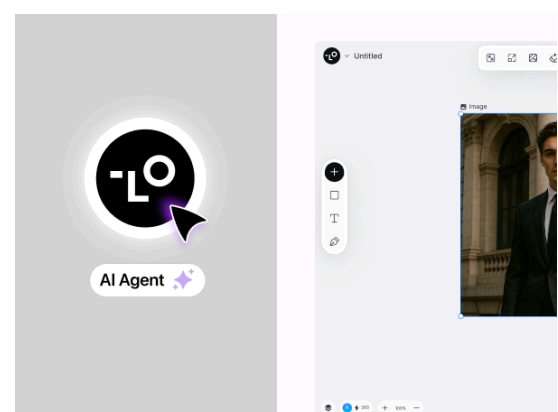
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Top titles include new releases like Britney Spears' "The Woman in Me" and Jesmyn Ward's "Let Us Descend," as well as those by other popular authors, like Janet Evanovich, John Grisham, Stephen King, Colleen Hoover and others, plus musical artists like Willie Nelson and Dave Grohl. Spotify says its catalog now includes over 70% of bestselling titles, including books from the big five publishers as well as independent publishers and authors. The titles range across genres, and also include classics, like Emily Brontë's "Wuthering Heights."

With the addition, Spotify hopes its Premium subscription will become more compelling as it will now offer an on-demand music catalog of over 100 tracks and more than 5 million podcasts, as well as the now 200,000 audiobooks.

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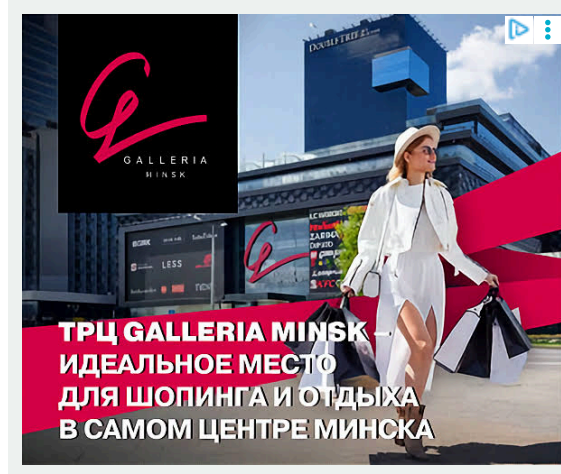
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In its [most recent quarter](#), Spotify grew paying subscribers by 16% year-over-year to 226 million and its monthly active users



grew 26% to 574 million — 2 million ahead of the company’s forecast. Revenue was also up 11% year-over-year to €3.4 billion (\$3.63 billion USD), as Spotify benefited from recent price hikes.

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